

Artis S320

The Artis S320 sports good looks and was one of the few that provided stands for the satellites. The controls for adjusting the main volume, treble and bass levels are provided



Artis S320

Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Warranty & support	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

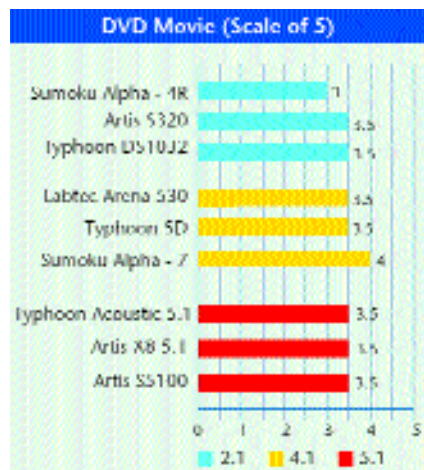
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on the subwoofer. This was one of the few speakers in the category that was able to reproduce treble effects with utmost clarity and is a good choice if you prefer to listen to pop and instrumental music. At Rs 2,000, it offers a good choice for a 2.1 speaker system.

Movie sound quality: Even though the 2.1 speakers category essentially comprised of stereo speakers, we tested them for DVD movie playback to ascertain their ability to handle loud and defined audio for voice and stereo panning. While most of the speakers delivered average results, the Typhoon DS1032 and the Artis S320 really stood out in terms of power output. These speakers were able to simulate surround sound even though they are essentially stereo speakers—the panning effect of sound flying from one speaker to another was reproduced very well.

In the 4.1 category, the speakers that delivered especially powerful audio and positioning during movie playback were the Labtec Arena 530 and the Artis S880. The Frontech JIL 1885 didn't do too well, with its very average response in playing back the surround audio. The Sumoku Alpha - 7, the Mercury SW 1980 and the Typhoon 5D were unable to position audio around the listener as they are basically stereo speakers bundled with four satellites.

A 5.1 speaker set can transport you into the middle of a surround sound-rich DVD movie. To test this, we hand-picked some VOB files with an array of pan and fade effects that send sounds flying all around you. For those who like to watch DVD movies at room-shaking volume levels, the answer is the Artis X8—the overall panning and background effects were excellent with this speaker.



er. One of the VOB files consisted of a camera flyby inside an ice cave: here, the sounds reproduced by the rear speakers were simply stunning. The overall movie experience is further enhanced by the subwoofer's ability to reproduce low frequency sounds faithfully and with the room-thumping power that DVD movies warrant. The

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